

Lab 1.2: Execute a Close and Transition Plan

Introduction

This hands-on lab gives you practice with the full closing sequence: reading a buyer's signals, choosing the right closing technique, and planning a smooth handoff to delivery. You will work from a realistic scenario, decide how you would close, and draft the key elements of a post-close transition plan that keeps the new customer confident and prevents buyer's remorse.

Learning Objectives

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- Identify genuine buying signals in a sales conversation.
- Select a closing technique that fits the situation.
- Draft the key elements of a post-close transition plan using the Handoff Checklist Template.



Scenario

You are an Account Executive at PayPro Solutions. You have been working with a fast-growing technology startup that currently uses a different payroll and benefits provider but has outgrown it. Over several conversations, your main contact, the startup's Head of People, has become increasingly engaged.

In your most recent call, she said the following:

"Our current provider just cannot keep up with how fast we are hiring."

"If we switched, how long would it take to get everyone moved over?"

"Would our managers need much training to use your self-service portal?"

"What would pricing look like for a team our size, around ninety people?"

"We would want this sorted before our next funding round closes in about six weeks."

Your task is to decide how to close this deal and plan the transition from their current provider.

Tools Overview

Handoff Checklist Template

The downloadable template from this lesson used to capture scope, success criteria, risks, and the post-close momentum plan.

Resource Files

- Handoff Checklist Template (DOCX)

- Lab 1.2 Exemplar Solution (DOCX)

Instructions

Exercise 1: Identify the Buying Signals

Objective: Find the signals that show this buyer is ready to move forward.

Step 1: Review the conversation

Read back through what the Head of People said. List each statement that functions as a buying signal and note what kind of signal it is (for example, a timeline question, a pain point, or a pricing question for their specific size).

Step 2: Note the urgency driver

Identify the legitimate business driver that creates real urgency here and explain why it is genuine rather than manufactured.

Exercise 2: Choose Your Closing Technique

Objective: Select a close that fits this buyer and situation.

Step 1: Decide on a technique

Choose whether an assumptive, alternative, or collaborative close fits best here, and write one or two sentences explaining why. Consider how strong the signals are and how much this buyer values being in control.

Step 2: Draft your closing line

Write the actual sentence or two you would use to move this buyer toward commitment, using the technique you chose. Tie it to the funding-round timeline.

Exercise 3: Draft the Transition Plan

Objective: Plan the handoff that keeps this customer confident after they sign.

Step 1: Capture scope and success

Using the Handoff Checklist Template, note what was promised and how this customer would define success. Remember they are switching from another provider, so a clean migration matters.

Step 2: Flag the risks

Identify at least two risks in this transition (for example, data migration from the old provider, or timing against the funding round) and note how you would manage each.

Step 3: Plan the first steps

List the first actions after signing: a kickoff date, an early quick win, and a first check-in, designed to keep the customer confident during the switch.

Lab Output / Expected Outcome

By the end of this lab, you should have a brief written summary that includes:

- A list of the buyer's signals and the real urgency driver.

- Your chosen closing technique, with a one or two sentence rationale and a sample closing line.

The key elements of a transition plan: scope, success criteria, at least two risks with mitigations, and a first-steps momentum plan.

Summary

Congratulations. You have worked a deal from buying signals to signed-and-transitioning customers. Reading signals, matching your close to the moment, and planning a clean handoff are what turn a likely deal into a successful, lasting account. Compare your work to the Lab 1.2 Exemplar Solution to see one strong approach.
